PD-1/PD-L1s:

Bavencio (Avelumab), Imfinzi (Durvalumab), Jemperli (Dostarlimab), Keytruda (Pembrolizumab), Keytruda Qlex (Pembrolizumab and berahyaluronidase alfa-pmph), Libtayo (Cemiplimab), Loqtorzi (Toripalimab), Opdivo (Nivolumab), Opdivo Qvantig (nivolumab and hyaluronidase-nvhy), Opdualag (Nivolumab and Relatimab-rmbw), Penpulimab-kcqx, Tecentriq (Atezolizumab), Tecentriq Hybreza (atezolizumab and hyaluronidase-tqjs), Tevimbra (Tislelizumab), Unloxcyt (cosibelimab-ipdl), Zynyz (Retifanlimab-dlwr)

Original Effective Date: 11/1/2023
Revision Date(s): 11/1/23; 2/1/24; 2/23/24; 4/16/24; 4/29/24; 7/1/24; 7/30/2024; 9/4/2024; 10/2/2024; 1/21/2025; 5/27/2025; 07/01/2025; 11/17/2025; 4/1/2026
Review Date: 4/1/2026
Policy type: Medical Necessity
Line of Business: All G.E.H.A Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan, or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety, and tolerability.

Maximum total length of initial therapy with PD-1/PD-L1 Inhibitor for metastatic non-small cell lung cancer is 2 years[1,2].

Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
    - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
    - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**
- Other uses of drugs and biologics may be considered medically necessary if supported as safe and effective according to peer-reviewed articles from one of the following journals:
    - American Journal of Medicine; Annals of Internal Medicine; Annals of Oncology; Annals of Surgical Oncology; Biology of Blood and Marrow Transplantation; Blood; Bone Marrow

[1] Sun L, Bleiberg B, Hwang W, et al. Association Between Duration of Immunotherapy and Overall Survival in Advanced Non–Small Cell Lung Cancer. JAMA Oncol. 2023;9(8):1075–1082.